

Plurals

A NOUN'S PLURAL FORM IS USED WHEN THERE IS MORE THAN ONE OF SOMETHING.

The word *plural* refers to the form a noun takes when more than one thing is being mentioned. Most nouns have distinctive singular and plural forms.

Regular plural nouns

The most common way to make a noun plural is to add *s* or *es* to the end of the singular form. Most nouns take the ending *-s*, except for those ending in *-s*, *-z*, *-x*, *-sh*, *-ch*, or *-ss*, which take the suffix (ending) *-es*.

One **dragon**
Two **dragons**

One **wish**
Two **wishes**

Follow the rules

Some nouns are given different plural endings to make them easier to pronounce. In most cases, it's possible to follow a few simple rules. If a word ends in *-y*, for example, and it has a vowel before the final *-y*, the plural is formed in the usual way: An *s* is added. If the final *-y* is preceded by a consonant, however, the *y* must be changed to *i*, followed by the ending *-es*.

If a word, such as *cactus*, has been borrowed from **Latin**, the Latin plural form (here, *cacti*) is often used.

